

Borderlands 2 is out!

The sequel of the popular game from Gearbox developers is available now. Shoot and loot was never this exciting

**Intel Haswell**

Intel recently showcased its 20nm Haswell chip which is 20 times more power efficient than Ivy Bridge and due to release in 2013



ASUS O!Play Mini

O!Play Mini and Flash TV HD, but that's only because of the category it happens to fall into. It's about as big as two 3.5-inch desktop hard drives kept one on top of the other. The front and the sides are built of shiny plastic, but the top has a matte finish, which is good because matte finishes attract fewer fingerprints and hide dust collection better. On the left you will find a USB and an E-SATA port – the E-SATA also doubles as another USB port. The AV connectivity ports are on the back, along with optical audio and an Ethernet port.

Seagate's GoFlex TV is about the same size as the ASUS O!Play HDP R1/2A. Pop open the front panel and you see a slot for a 2.5-inch GoFlex hard drive. Remember, though, that this slot is only for Seagate GoFlex portable drives, and you can't connect just any drive you want to here. The sides have vents to keep the system cool, particularly when there is a drive slot-in. The USB port is on the back, along with composite, component and HDMI for video, and optical out for audio. The finish is just the right mix of glossy and matte black.

The WD Live Hub, when it was first released, did change the way HD media players were perceived. Rather than just being something to get your media on to your TV, it

brought with it a sense of style and purpose. The Live Hub is only slightly wider and deeper than the O!Play HDP R1/2A, but is 50 per cent slimmer. Consider the fact that there is a 1TB 2.5-inch internal hard drive packed into this form factor, and you are even more impressed.

Although this device has a fan to blow warm air out the bottom, it still is one of the coolest running and most silent devices in this test.

If you happen to hate flashy looking colours distracting you from your TV screen, you are even given the option to turn off the LED logo that's on the front. On the back you find all the AV connectivity options, the Ethernet port and a USB ports – there's another in front. This is one of only two devices in this comparison test that actually

have a physical power on/off key – the Boxee Box is the other.

The O!Play Air looks exactly like the O!Play HDP R1/2A, except that one of the sides gets multiple card readers and the front gets an LED indicating the status of Wi-Fi connectivity. The tone of design similarity continues with the O!Play Mini Plus, which has exactly the same form factor as the O!Play Mini, but for a different top panel finish and an additional E-SATA and Ethernet port. The diamond patterned design on the top panel looks very classy, but sadly, just like its lower priced sibling, the front is ruined by a USB port and a memory card slot.

The O!Play HD2 is, and there is no other way of putting this, enormous. Of course this is partly because it has a slot for a 3.5-inch internal desktop drive for additional storage. If you don't plan on throwing in a TB or three of desktop storage, this will be an irritation, if you do, an acceptable inconvenience.

The design seems quite confused as well. The lines and curves don't seem to follow a theme. The glossy build doesn't help matters, and it has a whole range of ports on the front – USB, E-SATA, CF card, SD/MMC and

MS/MS Duo. No arguing with the sheer variety of devices that you can connect to this. The AV connectivity ports and Ethernet are on the rear panel. Will it win any awards for good looks, certainly not, but the idea seems to be simple – make the storage and connectivity ports easy to access for everyone (and thus improve ergonomics), looks be damned!

With the 2012 refresh of the WD Live, the bar has been raised that much higher now. Compared to the version it is phasing out, the thickness and the width of the player has been further reduced. One USB port shifts from the side to the front panel while the other one remains at the back where the with AV connections are.

It is a slightly darker shade of grey, with a block of black on the front where the power LED is placed. Speaking of which, the front LED on this one is just a dot, unlike the full WD logo that is lit up on the front of the Live Hub.

Out of the box, the Portronics LimeBox looks more like an Atom-based media centre PC. The design is quite unique, and the combination of white and light green gel quite well. The power on/off button on the arch stands out. On the top is the SD card slot, with a well-deployed cover. On the back are 2 USB ports, along with the HDMI out, composite video, optical audio and Ethernet port. More than anything else, this HD media player will have your guests asking questions about it!

The Amkette Evo TV looks like a cross between the WD Live and the Apple TV – in a good way. The form factor is very compact, and it's a combination of a matte and glossy finish. There are 3 USB ports on one side plus a memory card slot, while on the back you will



ASUS O!Play HDP R1/2A